

HSBC (HSBC.L/000.5.HK): 30th European Financials Conference — Key Takeaways

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Chris Hallam
+44(20)7552-2958 |
chris.hallam@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Melissa Kuang, CFA
+65-6889-2869 |
melissa.kuang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Benjamin Caven-Roberts
+44(20)7552-7066 | benjamin.d.caven-
roberts@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Sachin Nayar
+44(20)7051-2598 |
sachin.x.nayar@gs.com
Goldman Sachs International

Wayne Wang
+65-6889-2866 |
wayne.q.wang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Presenters: Georges Elhedery, Group Chief Executive, presented at our 30th Goldman Sachs European Financials Conference 2026.

Bottom Line: Management discussed: 1) structural trends within the current global environment; 2) wealth opportunities in particular; and 3) ongoing simplification efforts and the re-allocation of investment.

Key Takeaways

Structural growth opportunities given diversified global presence: Management noted that HSBC is well-positioned to benefit from various global trends given its scale across over 50 countries, particularly via the bank's extensive and historical Asia presence, with outsized economic growth, an increasing labour market, and strong FDI inflows within the region; alongside the reconfiguration of overall global networks, enabling the bank to serve the heightened demands of clients. Across the broader Asia region, management emphasised how intra-region trade flows have accelerated since the tariff events of 2025, while in the CIB business >85% of clients are multi-jurisdictional (with >65% of revenues generated in Western countries), highlighting the importance of HSBC as a global bank. Focussing on Hong Kong, management emphasised its role as a launchpad and inter-connector between mainland China and the rest of the world, while noting that Hong Kong has recently surpassed Switzerland as the largest wealth hub globally.

Wealth proposition: With >\$1.6tn in wealth balances, of which >\$1tn is in Asia (making it the largest player in the region), management emphasised its scale advantage in terms of riding the wealth-creation wave throughout the region. Furthermore, HSBC's booking centre presence across 8 regions (including Hong Kong, Singapore, Luxembourg, Switzerland etc.) places the bank at a competitive advantage, per management, given clients' heightened demand for jurisdictional diversification in the current geopolitical environment.

Simplification efforts: Regarding ongoing progress across the bank's simplification

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strategy, management noted that over the past couple of years the majority of decisions to exit non-returning and non-strategic businesses have already occurred, with the focus going forward on how to re-allocate investment and capital selectively, while continuing to leverage enhanced AI/technology solutions to decommission remaining legacy products, cost centres, and certain smaller level entities. Management noted that this narrowed scope enhances the safety of the bank, given fewer potential exposures across its various platforms.

Valuation/Risks

We value HSBC using a target multiple of 12.0x applied 75%/25% to 2027/28E estimates to arrive at 12-month target prices of GBP1,700/HK\$165. We are Buy rated (on Conviction List). Risks to our rating and price target include: 1) Weaker-than-expected Banking NII, including faster-than-expected Fed rate cuts, or a widening gap between HIBOR and Fed rate; 2) Slower-than-expected non-NII growth, including a potential slowdown in global trade or increased competition from peers; 3) Reversal/pause of positive operating efficiency trajectory if simplification efforts are impacted adversely.

Investment Thesis

We are Buy rated on HSBC (HSBC.L/0005.HK), as we see the Group sustaining a stronger earnings and returns phase that is yet to be fully reflected in valuation. HSBC is a global liquidity engine. Across European, Asian and Global peers, we believe it presents a near-unique combination of: 1) a scaled deposit franchise, ii) consistent and structural growth and iii) a liquidity focused balance sheet. This capital-light, liability-led growth strategy benefits from structural dynamics underpinning the deposit and wealth trends in SE Asia (see: [Riding Asia's liquidity wave; the earnings engine of HK/ SG Banks](#)) as well as elevated global rates.

Disclosure Appendix

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Contributing Authors: Chris Hallam Goldman Sachs International, Melissa Kuang, CFA Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte, Benjamin Caven-Roberts Goldman Sachs International, Sachin Nayar Goldman Sachs International, Wayne Wang Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte.

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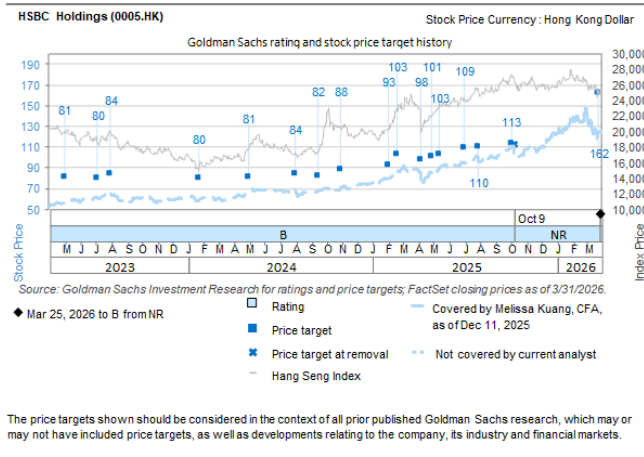
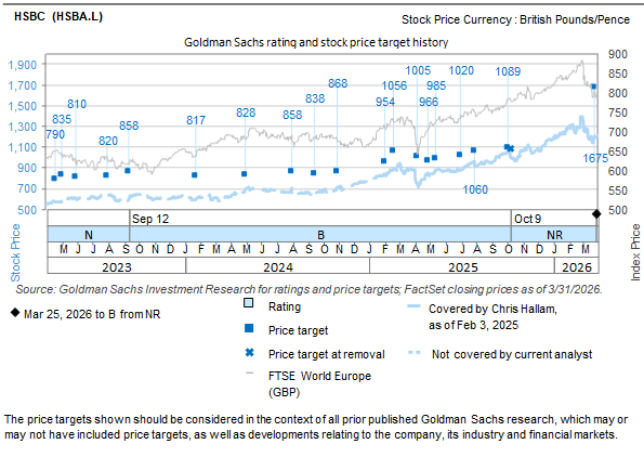
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

HSBC (HSBA.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
05-May-26	1,700	1,279.8
10-Apr-26	1,650	1,340.2
25-Mar-26	1,675	1,211.4
03-Oct-25	1,089	1,061.8
30-Jul-25	1,060	926
02-Jul-25	1,020	885.3
13-May-25	985	876.1
29-Apr-25	966	855.6
07-Apr-25	1,005	737.8
19-Feb-25	1,056	895.4
02-Feb-25	954	845.7
29-Oct-24	868	713.7
14-Sep-24	838	658.7
31-Jul-24	858	704
30-Apr-24	828	695.6
23-Jan-24	817	598.8
12-Sep-23	858	597.3
01-Aug-23	820	654.9

HSBC Holdings (0005.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
05-May-26	165.00	136.00
10-Apr-26	160.00	139.70
25-Mar-26	162.00	125.00
03-Oct-25	113.00	109.90
30-Jul-25	110.00	96.95
02-Jul-25	109.00	95.25
13-May-25	103.00	89.65
29-Apr-25	101.00	88.35
07-Apr-25	98.00	73.40
19-Feb-25	103.00	88.40
02-Feb-25	93.00	79.95
29-Oct-24	88.00	71.60
14-Sep-24	82.00	67.30
31-Jul-24	84.00	69.95
30-Apr-24	81.00	67.00
23-Jan-24	80.00	59.20
01-Aug-23	84.00	66.30
06-Jul-23	80.00	61.00

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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